



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
NPCJ Standard Operating Procedures for the Records Management

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Standard Operating Procedure (Sop) for the NPCJ Records Management System

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1.0 INTRODUCTION

This SOP is mandatory for all personnel in the Registry Department. Strict adherence is essential to uphold the records management system's integrity, security, and efficiency, which is central to the department's operations. Regular training and supervision will reinforce compliance and support continuous improvement in managing institutional records.

2.0 PURPOSE

To establish comprehensive and practical procedures that ensures the effective creation, classification, handling, security, storage, and disposal of records. This SOP supports the Registry Department in maintaining high standards in records lifecycle management, from receipt to archiving or destruction. It also governs related tasks such as correspondence handling, inventory control, data system updates, and staff supervision, each anchored in the broader objective of ensuring reliable and accountable records management.

3.0 SCOPE

This SOP applies to all personnel in the Registry Department, including Senior Registry Officers, Clerks, Dispatchers, and other support staff involved in managing physical or digital records and documentation systems.

4.0 RESPONSIBILITIES

- 4.1 It is the responsibility of the Administrative Supervisor/Manager** to provide oversight of records systems, ensure strategic alignment with organisational policies, and lead compliance monitoring.
- 4.2 It is the responsibility of the Senior Registry Officer** to supervise daily records operations, uphold metadata integrity, and manage staff performance related to records processes.
- 4.3 It is the responsibility of the Registry Officers, Clerks, and Dispatchers** to Execute assigned tasks in line with records handling protocols, ensuring all documents are accurately logged, secured, retrieved, or archived.

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5.0 OPERATIONAL PROCEDURES

5.1 CUSTOMER SERVICE

- 5.1.1 Respond courteously and professionally to all internal and external enquiries, ensuring prompt attention to requests.
- 5.1.2 Provide accurate, clear, and helpful information, and if unable to assist directly, refer Enquiries to the appropriate personnel.
- 5.1.3 Maintain a welcoming and professional demeanour to foster positive relationships.
- 5.1.4 Maintain confidentiality of sensitive information at all times.
- 5.1.5 Follow up on unresolved enquiries to ensure complete resolution within the shortest possible time.
- 5.1.6 Record feedback or complaints and escalate for resolution to improve service quality.

5.2 RECEIVING AND DISPATCHING CORRESPONDENCE

- 5.2.1 Collect incoming mail, packages, files and correspondences from Police Headquarters, Divisions, Post Office, and other stakeholders.
- 5.2.2 Log each item immediately into the designated register, noting date, sender/receiver, and description.
- 5.2.3 Record files and correspondences in the appropriate registers.
- 5.2.4 Ensure all entries in the dispatch registers are accurate, complete, and legible, capturing details such as date received, sender, recipient, description, signatures and reference number.
- 5.2.5 Maintain these registers, keeping them up-to-date and clean.
- 5.2.6 Classify correspondences according to the established classification system, ensuring consistency.
- 5.2.7 Distribute correspondence promptly to the relevant departments or personnel, ensuring confidentiality.
- 5.2.8 Prepare outgoing mail and packages, record dispatch details accurately, and track delivery status until confirmed.
- 5.2.9 Report any delays, damages, or issues immediately to supervisors.
- 5.2.10 Maintain a record of all dispatches and receipts for accountability.

5.3 RECORD AND FILE MANAGEMENT

- 5.3.1 Sign for all received files and correspondence, and date stamp upon receipt.
- 5.3.2 Assign reference numbers immediately, ensuring they follow the sequential order and match the classification system.

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- 5.3.3 Record reference numbers, descriptions, dates, sender, and recipient details in the dispatch database.
- 5.3.4 Use reference numbers consistently; prevent duplication or misallocation.
- 5.3.5 Create personnel files and labels immediately upon receipt of new documents.
- 5.3.6 Store physical files in designated cabinets in an organized, logical sequence, accessible for authorized staff.
- 5.3.7 Regularly update the HQ File Tracking System for all file movements—check-in, check-out, transfer, or archiving.
- 5.3.8 Remove inactive or obsolete files for archiving or disposal following approved protocols and with proper authorization.
- 5.3.9 Conduct weekly audits for accuracy, completeness, and security of files and records.
- 5.3.10 Properly dispose of records containing sensitive information only with prior written approval and following legal and organizational guidelines.

5.4 DATA ENTRY AND SYSTEM MAINTENANCE

- 5.4.1 Daily update of the HQ File Tracking System.
- 5.4.2 Periodical update of Leave Database, Nominal Roll, and Re-enlistment Database.
- 5.4.3 Ensure spreadsheets are properly formatted with clear headings, formulas, and data validation to minimize errors.
- 5.4.4 Save all Excel files in designated shared drives with appropriate naming conventions.
- 5.4.5 Save scanned copies of documents securely in designated folders, linking them to the digital record system where applicable.
- 5.4.6 Ensure all digital files are named systematically with relevant identifiers (e.g., personnel ID, date, document type).
- 5.4.7 Conduct weekly audits of data entries to identify inconsistencies or errors.
- 5.4.8 Correct identified discrepancies immediately and document corrections made.
- 5.4.9 Maintain logs of data updates, including date, nature of change, and personnel responsible.
- 5.4.10 Regularly backup all electronic records, including Excel files, to secure servers or cloud storage.
- 5.4.11 Restrict access to sensitive data to authorized personnel only.
- 5.4.12 Maintain a log of system access and changes for audit purposes.
- 5.4.13 Verify data entries with physical documents for accuracy.

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- 5.4.14 Perform weekly data validation and correction of discrepancies.
- 5.4.15 Backup electronic records regularly to prevent data loss and ensure recoverability.

5.5 INVENTORY AND STATIONERY MANAGEMENT

- 5.5.1 Monitor stock levels daily via the Inventory Management System.
- 5.5.2 Prepare procurement requests when stocks reach reorder points, and submit to procurement.
- 5.5.3 Store stationery and supplies in designated, secure storage areas or cabinets, ensuring they are organized and secured.
- 5.5.4 Restrict access to storage areas to authorized personnel only.
- 5.5.5 Distribute stationery and supplies strictly to authorized staff and departments based on approved requisitions.
- 5.5.6 Maintain a distribution log to record who received what, when, and in what quantity, for accountability purposes.
- 5.5.7 Distribute stationery and supplies efficiently, timely, ensuring equitable and accountable distribution.
- 5.5.8 Record all inventory movements immediately to maintain accurate stock records.
- 5.5.9 Conduct monthly stock reconciliations and reconcile physical counts with system records.

5.6 SORTING AND DISTRIBUTION OF PAYSLIP

- 5.6.1 Handle payslip distribution with strict confidentiality and professionalism.
- 5.6.2 Ensure payslips are sorted securely, maintaining confidentiality at all times.
- 5.6.3 Distribute payslips promptly to staff or designated recipients, adhering to deadlines.
- 5.6.4 Use secure methods to transport and hand over payslips to prevent unauthorized access.
- 5.6.5 Ensure proper documentation of distribution, including signatures or acknowledgment receipts.
- 5.6.6 Maintain a log of all payslip distributions, ensuring timeliness and confidentiality.

5.7 STAFF SUPERVISION AND TRAINING

- 5.7.1 Supervise Registry Clerks and Dispatchers daily, assigning tasks clearly and monitoring completion.

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- 5.7.2 Schedule staff rotations, training sessions, and welfare activities to promote efficiency and wellbeing.
- 5.7.3 Conduct weekly performance briefings and provide constructive feedback.
- 5.7.4 Address performance or conduct issues promptly and document accordingly.
- 5.7.5 Ensure timely completion and submission of staff appraisals and development plans.

5.8 VEHICLE AND ASSET MANAGEMENT

- 5.8.1 Maintain service motorcycles and vehicles in good operational condition.
- 5.8.2 Record daily usage, defects, and maintenance needs in logbooks.
- 5.8.3 Schedule repairs promptly and ensure that authorised service providers carry out repairs.
- 5.8.4 Follow all safety protocols during vehicle operation, including adherence to traffic laws.
- 5.8.5 Conduct regular inspections for safety compliance and vehicle cleanliness.
- 5.8.6 Record all vehicle movements and ensure logbooks are updated accurately.
- 5.8.7 Secure all departmental assets and report any loss, theft, or damage immediately.

5.9 REPORTING, PERFORMANCE MONITORING, AND CONTINUAL IMPROVEMENT

- 5.9.1 Compile weekly and monthly operational reports covering correspondence processing, inventory status, file management, staff activities, and system updates.
- 5.9.2 Submit reports on schedule to facilitate management review and decision-making.
- 5.9.3 Use reports to identify operational gaps, inefficiencies, or risks, and recommend corrective actions.
- 5.9.4 Maintain records of all reports and supporting documentation for accountability.
- 5.9.5 Support other departments or activities as required, including special projects or urgent requests.
- 5.9.6 Respond swiftly and effectively to unexpected operational demands or emergencies, following established protocols for data breaches, security threats, or safety hazards.
- 5.9.7 Conduct quarterly reviews of procedures to incorporate technological advancements, compliance updates, and staff feedback.
- 5.9.8 Collect input and suggestions from staff to improve workflows and enhance operational efficiency.

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5.9.9 Update this SOP as necessary, with approval from senior management, to reflect best practices and operational improvements.

5.10 HEALTH, SAFETY, AND SECURITY

5.10.1 Follow all safety procedures when handling mail, packages, and operating vehicles.

5.10.2 Use personal protective equipment where applicable.

5.10.3 Ensure secure handling and storage of sensitive documents and data.

5.10.4 Maintain a clean and organised work environment to prevent accidents.

5.10.5 Report hazards, unsafe practices, or security breaches immediately to supervisors.

5.10.6 Conduct regular safety audits and ensure compliance with organisational safety standards.

5.10.7 Secure all physical and digital records against unauthorised access.

5.11 REVISION

This SOP is to be revised every three years to ensure its completeness and accuracy. This will identify areas for improvement, address gaps or inconsistencies, and make necessary updates to maintain high quality and standards in alignment with the Jamaica Constabulary Force Strategic Priorities for Organisational Restructuring and Capacity Building.